

From: [Smith, Andy E. \(DHHS\)](#)
To: [Paulu, Chris](#)
Subject: RE: CP - work update, weeks ending 07/11/2008
Date: Monday, July 14, 2008 1:31:40 PM

Thanks Chris, these are really helpful. See some comments below. Add a section for deadlines.

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From: Paulu, Chris
Sent: Monday, July 14, 2008 1:03 PM
To: Smith, Andy E. (DHHS)
Subject: CP - work update, weeks ending 07/11/2008

On my Plate

- EPHT – Portal development
 - Lead maps, reporting
 - Water CWG – data, conference calls, sharing agreement
 - Address Geocoding Tool
 - Asthma/air surveillance
 - Cognos assistance
 - Arsenic in wells mapping project
 - Birth outcomes multi-state project
- Lead
 - data requests (Auburn-Lewiston HUD proposal)
 - address cleaning/geocoding, 2003-2007
 - Battelle risk prediction project
- Cancer – North Deering inquiry
 - geocoding protocol
- Program – Arsenic exposure study
- ME-CDC – Data Access Workgroup
- USM – misc.

This week's activities

EPHT

Portal development – lots of discussions. Some assistance/experimentation with Cognos. Bottom line for Cognos maps: Lisa can join data successfully; number of categories, colors and cutpoints are customizable, but with none of the automatic aids of ArcGIS, nor the symbology options (scaled dots, dot density). I don't believe there is any layering or zooming functionality, and there certainly isn't any capability to display an ad hoc set of latitude/longitude points. Right now we have county map display only. I need to generate an import file for PH Districts, towns, etc. We should make a list of display layers; it would be best to do this before my 30 day MapInfo demo expires.

Lead maps, reports – meeting with Kathy, Naomi. I have a summary of maps to be presented. I will forward it to the four of us for review. (See Lead topic below for discussion of address cleanup and geocoding).

Water CWG – data sharing agreement with DWP will be signed shortly. Revised NCDM code was implemented and XML data files generated. It seemed to work smoothly, and XML validated. Prior to submission I will attend a conference call about sensible QC steps, and will explore the data for errors (original and calculation glitches). Final submission slated for Thursday, 7/17. *Metadata* – I'm not planning to update metadata yet, based on a chat with Rish V. last week. There was some conflicting information from SND though (via Lisa).

Address Geocoding Tool – I have tested a single-address web interface, and provided comments on a 0.0.1 version. I have a meeting today (7/14) with Mike F. to discuss (I preferred email, but he insisted on face-to-face). I think the Tool sucks considerably less than it used to. They have added an option to use NAVTEQ data, and it reports back to the user the “nearest match” when a suitable match is not found. However, much of the verbiage is still bogus, and Lisa and Cindy found it to be pretty lame. It concerns me that my opinion is less harsh: it could be that my expectations of OIT work have hit the basement level. [Keep pushing them Chris.](#)

Asthma/Air Surveillance – no developments

Birth Outcomes multi-state analysis – no news

Arsenic in wells mapping project – Charlie Culbertson will take this over. Need to summarize what I've done, outline what he can/should do, prior to meeting.

Lead

Data request – Auburn-Lewiston data request for HUD grant. Tasks: devising census-unit based target area based on City request and inspection of EBL locations (2005-2006); geocoding of *screenees*, since HUD requests # of children tested and <10 children in target area and Auburn-Lewiston as a whole. There were ~2,000 screening-related addresses. Dual-source geocoding reduced the manual inspection load to about 5% (100 addresses).

Address cleaning/geocoding, general data QC – lots of discussion in Portal meeting; reviewed species of address validation “errors” (by direct inspection, and Lisa’s summary). I have some general observations on this – not yet circulated – and will take the lead to make sure it gets done (with assistance from Cindy, May, whoever).

Battelle risk prediction project – attended webinar. Generally impressed that the people working on this project are intelligent, capable, honest (“we’ll take whatever data we can get our grubby hands on” – I appreciated that line). They gave us a pre-print article (haven’t read it thoroughly). They’re project is all about “risk prediction” and I have reservations about this endeavor - as in, “what’s the point?” They talked about using the output “predicted risk” as a tool of intervention. But if the predicted risk far exceeds the observed EBLs, what does that tell us? Or vice-versa? Perhaps this works better in Massachusetts where they have extensive building inspection data. Not clear to me whether we should (and legally can) do this. Difficult to see what we gain, and while our statutory language will allow us to share address data, I am not sure we can share other data with them that would make it any easier to identify an individual. So, I suppose I need to better understand what they specifically want from us, data wise.

Cancer

North Deering inquiry – No developments really, but I know that I’ll be needed to check and review what Kathy does, perhaps generate some maps, etc., and this is a pretty big little project (I think). If it is a pretty big project, ..who is going to do this?

Geocoding protocol – I consider my work with Lead addresses and with the Address Tool as all feeding into a geocoding protocol that Cancer will use.

Program

Arsenic Exposure Study – No developments. It would be nice to schedule a future time to work on this. – Some developments that I may not have told you about. I have (over the past few months) collected a number of toe nail samples from my self. I have sent them to the lab to be weighed to see if enough mass to either split in half or three-ways. Looks like answer is yes, but for big toe nail samples only. HETL is willing to assist us with a pilot soaking study. Plan is to take a big toe nail sample (3 or 4 of them), split into thirds: one part is saved as control, one is soaked for 48-hours in 500 ppb arsenate, the third part is soaked in 500 ppb arsenite for 48 hours. Samples are then shipped off to Dartmouth for analysis. This, I am hoping will tell us whether we have a toe nail issue or not. Any hint we do, then we move forward with paper with urine data only, as we try to find a way to undertake a more robust study. If no evidence of any adsorption from soaking,we write paper with both results and scratch our head. Sound OK? Hope to have pilot study run in August.

ME-CDC

Data Workgroup – You were there. Meeting + trial experimentation with the demo Data Access site. I’m still not sure what to make of it in general, but it strikes me as a

different approach to some similar information access objectives as the EPHT Portal. So it has complementary advantages and disadvantages. Our groups can learn from each other's efforts.

USM

Meetings, goings-on – No developments (it's summer), aside from travel budgeting and Overhead bargaining.

[ADD Pending Deadlines section](#)

Time spent:

- 40% - EPHT Portal-related
- 35% - Lead support/data request
- 15% - Water CWG: data generation, conference calls
- 5% - Geocoding Tool development
- <5% - ME-CDC Data Access Workgroup
- <5% - this update